

UREL-1103, UREL-1106, UREL-1202**Modal Auxiliaries/ Modals**

Can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, ought to, have to, need, and dare are common modals.

Uses:

Can: To express ability. It is used for present activities. *I can solve the problem now.*

Could: To express the ability: It is used-

- Often as past form of *can*. *Yesterday I could solve the problem.*
- To request someone to do something: *Could you wait for me a little bit?*

* Since there is no future form of *can*, the ability in future should be expressed with 'be able to': *I shall be able to solve the problem tomorrow.*

May: Used (present/future)

- To express probability: *It may rain now.*
- To ask permission: *May I come in sir?*
- To pray for someone: *May Allah bless you.*

Might: Used-

- Often as past form of *may*: *You might solve the problem yesterday.*
- To express future probability: *He might come tomorrow.*

Should: Used to express advisability in present/future: *You should send the letter now./tomorrow.*

Would: Used-

- Often as past form of *will*: *The doctor said that he would prescribe me a medicine.*
- To ask something politely: *Would you please tell me the matter?*

Ought to: To express advisability: *We ought to obey our parents.*

Have to: To express obligation in present, past and future tenses.

I have to help my neighbors always. (Present)

I had to wait for the result for hours together. (Past)

I'll have to submit the application before 30th instant. (Future)

Need: Used in negative sentences as modal: *You need not apply for the post.*

Dare: Commonly used in question. *How dare you disobey me?*

Structures:

Affirmative: *Everybody should obey his elders.* (modal+present form of verb)

Negative: *You must not disobey your parents.* (modal+not+present form of verb)

Interrogative: *Should we wait for him?* (modal+sub.)

WH question: *Why should I help him?* (WH word+modal)

Passive: *This task must be completed within two days.* (modal+be+p.p. of verb)

Exercise: Fill up the gaps with suitable modals:

1. You-----not remain absent from the class.
2. The sky is cloudy. It -----rain soon.
3. He-----solve the problem yesterday.
4. This man-----do any difficult task.
5. You-----not disclose this secret to any body.
6. -----we help the man?
7. The machine -----be handled carefully.
8. He -----not wait for me.
9. -----we pay the fees before the fixed date?
10. -----you complete the task yesterday?

Modal+be

'Be' is used after a modal in two ways;

1. In passive structure:

- a. *The work should be accomplished within two days.*
 - b. *A criminal must be punished.*
 - c. *Our parents ought to be obeyed by us.*
(structure: modal+be+p.p. of verb)
2. In active structure, where 'be' will be main verb.
 - a. *You should be honest in your profession.*
 - b. *He may be at the office now.*
 - c. *We ought to be God fearing.*
(modal+be+adj./noun with preposition or article)

Exercise: Write two sentences with each of the following 'modal+be' (one sentence must be in passive, the other in active structure)---can be, could be, should be, ought to be, must be, would be, may be,

Modal based Correction

Correct the following sentences:

1. He must be gone there.
2. It may be rain within few minutes.
3. A good student should reward for his performance.
4. You must doing the work now.
5. He may arrives tomorrow.
6. You must do the work yesterday.
7. I shall can do the work tomorrow.
8. Our parents ought to obey us.
9. You must be do the work according to my instruction.
10. An idle man must be suffered in the long run.
11. Your computer must update for better performance.
12. You should be obey the rules and regulations of the institution.
13. You can be done the work now.
14. You must be submit the assignment tomorrow.
15. The children may be give right education.
16. This problem must solve without delay.
17. This secret must not disclose to anybody.
18. Yesterday I can solve the problem without your help.
19. A student should be cleaned the whiteboard.
20. Our result may publish tomorrow.

Answers:

1. He must go there.
2. It may rain within few minutes.
3. A good student should be rewarded for his performance.
4. You must do the work now.
5. He may arrive tomorrow.
6. You must have done the work yesterday.
7. I shall be able to do the work tomorrow.
8. Our parents ought to be obeyed by us.
9. You must do the work according to my instruction.
10. An idle man must suffer in the long run.
11. Your computer must be updated for better performance.
12. You should obey the rules and regulations of the institution.
13. You can do the work now.
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15. The children may be given right education.
16. This problem must be solved without delay.
17. This secret must not be disclosed to anybody.
18. Yesterday I could solve the problem without your help.
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Modal + Perfective

1. Should + have+ p.p. (should have done)
 2. Could+ have+ p.p. (could have done)
 3. Must+ have+ p.p. (must have done)
 4. May+ have+ p.p. (may have done)
- Modal +perfectives are usually used to talk about past activities. First and second modal+ perfective mentioned above indicate that the activity did not hold in the past, such as 'you should have done' means that 'it was advisable for you to do, but you didn't do' and 'you could have done' means that you were able to do but you didn't do'. The third and fourth modal+ perfective indicate that the action happened in the past surely or probably, such as 'you must have done' means that 'surely you did' and 'you may have done' means that 'probably you did'.

Some sentences using modal + perfective	Transformation into other sentences without modal + perfective
Yesterday when I was helpless you could have helped me.	Yesterday when I was helpless you had the ability to help me, but you didn't.
You must have neglected your lessons in the last semester.	Certainly you neglected your lessons in the last semester.
You may have heard the name of Hajee Mohammad Muhsin	Probably you have heard the name of Hajee Mohammad Muhsin
It must have rained last night.	Surely it rained last night.
You could have waited for me.	You were able to wait for me but you didn't.
In spite of being good student you have failed. You must have neglected your studies.	In spite of being good student you have failed. Surely you have neglected your studies.
You could have helped your poor neighbor.	You were able to help your poor neighbor, but you didn't.
You must have waited for me for long time.	Certainly you waited for me for a long time.
He may have arrived there by this time.	Probably he arrived there by this time.
You could have consulted with me.	You had the opportunity to consult with me, but you didn't.
They should have waited for you.	It was good for them to wait for you, but they didn't.
You must have checked the mail.	Surely you have checked the mail.
He should have given you the message earlier.	It was necessary for him to give you the message earlier, but he didn't.
You may have forgotten my name.	Probably you have forgotten my name.
I could have bought the book.	I had the ability to buy the book, but I didn't.
The students must have understood the matter.	Certainly the students have understood the matter.
You may have got the news.	Probably you have got the news.
You could have avoided the accident.	It was within your capability to avoid the accident, but you didn't do it.
He must have followed your advice.	I am sure that he followed your advice.
They should have come earlier.	It was necessary for them to come earlier, but they didn't.

I should have asked you the question earlier.	It was good for me to ask you the question earlier, but I didn't
He must have suffered a lot for that.	Surely he suffered a lot for that.

Fill in the gaps with suitable modal and perfective of the verb within bracket.

1. Rahul was expelled from USA for having an expired visa. He ----- (renew) his visa in time.
2. Haji Mohammad Mushsin was a famous man. You -----(hear) his name.
3. The roads are muddy and there is water here and there. It----- (rain) last night.
4. Your neighbor died without treatment for lack of money. You----- (give) him some financial assistance.

You could have waited for me.
In spite of being good student you have failed. You must have neglected your studies.
You could have helped your poor neighbor.
You must have waited for me for long time.
He may have arrived there by this time.
You could have consulted with me.
They should have waited for you.
You must have checked the mail.
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You may have forgotten my name.
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